

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 5-00-232

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
MADERA COUNTY SERVICE AREA NO. 2
AND
UNITED STATES FOREST SERVICE
BASS LAKE WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MADERA COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. Madera County Service Area No. 2 (hereafter Discharger or County) owns and operates a wastewater collection system and treatment facility (WWTF) that provides sewage service for Bass Lake, a residential and resort community in eastern Madera County.
2. The WWTF includes headworks, two aeration basins, two secondary clarifiers, two open-air aerobic sludge digesters, chlorine contact basin, unlined effluent storage pond, seven concrete sludge-drying beds, and a sprayfield disposal system. The WWTF (not including sprayfields) is at an elevation of about 3,400 feet in Section 9, T7S, R22E, MDB&M, on land owned by the Discharger. A WWTF vicinity map and flow diagram are shown in Attachments A and B, respectively, parts of this Order. The WWTF has reported average and peak design flows of 0.50 million gallons per day (mgd) and 0.65 mgd, respectively.
3. The sprayfield disposal system includes two sprayfields, one of approximately 11 acres and one of approximately 20 acres, on a fenced 104-acre parcel of land owned by the United States Forest Service (USFS). The Discharger has a special use permit from the USFS for use of the land. The sprayfields are in a relatively remote location about 1.5 miles northwest of the treatment facilities on Taylor Mountain at an elevation of about 3,600 feet in the southwest quarter of Section 5, and northwest quarter of Section 8, T7S, R22E, MDB&M (Attachment A).
4. The sprayfields do not include a runoff collection and return system. The Discharger reports that it draws down the effluent storage reservoir by summer's end and avoids discharging to the sprayfields during rainfall.
5. The sprayfield disposal system originally included three sprayfields, each with a reported size of approximately 20 acres (however, one is only about 11 acres, as a portion shown on the original plans was never installed). One sprayfield (the middle one) was removed from service and dismantled because of severe freeze damage, and because of past chronic problems with effluent runoff entering a nearby spring-fed surface water drainage. The current disposal capacity of the sprayfield disposal area is unknown.
6. Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) Order No. 76-25, adopted by the Board on 7 February 1976 prior to completion of WWTF construction, prescribes requirements for a mean daily flow of up to

1.0 mgd (which exceeds "as-built" WWTF capacity). Order No. 76-25 contains numerical effluent limitations for biochemical oxygen demand, suspended solids, settleable solids, pH, and total coliform, and requires monitoring for all of these constituents and for effluent chlorine residual and storage pond dissolved oxygen (DO).

7. The majority of the domestic water supply (about 85-90%) for Service Area No. 2 is a combination of surface water diverted from Willow Creek and groundwater from wells, and is provided by the Bass Lake Water Company. The remaining supply comes from USFS facilities in the area and other private sources.
8. Order No. 76-25 is not adequate because it is not consistent with the current plans and policies of the Board, and because it specifies a maximum allowable discharge flow that exceeds WWTF capacity.

BASIN PLAN AND PROHIBITIONS

9. The Board adopted a *Water Quality Control Plan for the Sacramento River Basin and the San Joaquin River Basin, Fourth Edition* (hereafter Basin Plan), which designates beneficial uses, establishes water quality objectives, and contains implementation plans and policies for all waters of the basins. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.
10. On 14 December 1973, the Board adopted Order No. 74-127 prohibiting the further installation of individual sewage disposal systems and prohibiting the use of individual sewage disposal systems within Service Area No. 2 after 1 July 1977. This prohibition remains in effect and is included in the Basin Plan along with a policy that prohibits the discharge of municipal wastes to Willow Creek-Bass Lake.

HYDROLOGY, SOILS, AND BENEFICIAL USES

11. The WWTF (not including sprayfields) lies within the San Joaquin Hydrologic Basin, San Joaquin River Hydrologic Unit, North Fork Hydrologic Area, Wishon Hydrologic Subarea (No. 540.21), and adjacent to the Bass Lake Hydrologic Subarea (No. 540.22), as depicted on interagency hydrologic maps prepared by the California Department of Water Resources (DWR) in August 1986.
12. The sprayfield area lies within the San Joaquin Hydrologic Basin, Ahwahnee Hydrologic Unit, Fresno River Hydrologic Area, Coarsegold Creek Hydrologic Subarea (No. 539.31), as depicted on DWR's 1986 hydrologic maps.
13. The average annual precipitation, some of this as snow, in the WWTF vicinity (at Crane Valley Powerhouse) is approximately 39 inches, and the 100-year return period annual rainfall is about

79 inches, according to DWR Bulletin No. 195. In the vicinity (and on) the sprayfields, snow typically accumulates to a depth of about two feet before melting between snowstorms. The sprayfields do not include a runoff collection and return system.

14. Surface water runoff from the majority of the sprayfield area is to a branch of Redwood Creek, a tributary of Nelder Creek, which flows into the Fresno River above Hidden Reservoir in the vicinity of Oakhurst. Surface water runoff from a portion of the sprayfield area is to an unnamed stream that flows through the Oakhurst Valley and into the Fresno River above Hidden Reservoir. Surface water runoff from the WWTF storage pond and treatment unit area is to Slide Creek approximately 600 feet to the west. Slide Creek flows into Bass Lake about one mile from the WWTF. Bass Lake is an impoundment of Willow Creek created in the 1920's for hydroelectric power generation. Willow Creek flows into the San Joaquin River above Millerton Lake. The lake receives heavy water contact and noncontact recreational use, especially during summer months.
15. The beneficial uses of the Fresno River from its source to Hidden Reservoir are municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, water contact recreation, noncontact water recreation, warm freshwater habitat, cold freshwater habitat, and wildlife habitat.
16. The beneficial uses of the San Joaquin River from its source to Millerton Lake are municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, hydropower generation, water contact recreation, noncontact water recreation, warm freshwater habitat, cold freshwater habitat, and wildlife habitat.
17. Area groundwater is found in water-bearing fractures within underlying bedrock. Groundwater depth information is not available for the WWTF and sprayfield area.
18. The beneficial uses of groundwater underlying the WWTF and the sprayfields are municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, industrial service supply, and industrial process supply.

COLLECTION SYSTEM AND SPILL HISTORY

19. The Discharger reported (as of 4 August 2000) that the WWTF service area (or collection system) has 907 residential connections and 21 commercial connections. In terms of flow, the 21 commercial connections are equivalent to 508 single-family dwellings. Of the 508 single-family dwelling units, 200 are assigned to campgrounds. The remaining 308 single-family dwelling units are assigned to businesses such as hotels, restaurants, bed/breakfast inns, offices, bakeries, and laundromats.
20. Discharges of raw sewage to Bass Lake from the WWTF collection system have occurred numerous times during the past 10 years (and prior). Because the majority of the WWTF collection system is within 1/2 mile of the lake's shoreline and a portion lies along the lake bottom, any system spills have a high probability of entering the waters of Bass Lake. Between December

1991 and July 1994, there were seven documented raw sewage discharges (overflows) from the WWTF collection system to Bass Lake. On 10 August 1994, the Board issued Administrative Civil Liability (ACL) Order No. 94-285 for the illegal discharges.

21. In March 1995, the Discharger submitted a report, *Wastewater Collection and Pumping Station Work Plan Report*, dated February 1995 (1995 Work Plan). The 1995 Work Plan included recommendations that the County thoroughly clean the collection system, hire additional WWTF operation and maintenance personnel, mail notices to the public instructing them to abstain from flushing items which could cause collection system blockages, and investigate all food establishments for compliance with the County's grease trap ordinance. Following submittal of the 1995 Work Plan, the County reported an additional eight occurrences of raw sewage discharging from the WWTF collection system to Bass Lake. The size of the spills ranged from 75 to 100,000 gallons, and their reported causes included power failures, lift station malfunctions, and grease blockages. On 22 December 1998, staff contacted the County and requested information on the status of implementation of the 1995 Work Plan. The County has not provided a response. A 26 July 2000 inspection report indicates that the Discharger is currently improving the collection system's computerized monitoring and warning system.

CEQA AND ANTIDEGRADATION FINDINGS

22. The action to adopt waste discharge requirements for this existing facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15301.
23. The discharge to land as permitted herein is consistent with the antidegradation provisions of Resolution No. 68-16 in that it allows for no groundwater degradation. In the absence of groundwater quality monitoring data, it is unknown whether there is assimilative capacity available in the underlying groundwater, considering limited dilution, to allow for some degradation and not unreasonably threaten present and anticipated beneficial use of such water or result in groundwater that exceeds or threatens to exceed water quality objectives set forth in the Basin Plan. Such degradation, if it occurs, will likely be limited to groundwater underlying the effluent storage pond. This Order requires the Discharger to monitor groundwater in this area to assess whether the discharge of effluent to the effluent storage pond has degraded groundwater. Some degradation of groundwater immediately underlying the effluent storage pond is allowable provided the discharge reflects the implementation of best practicable treatment and control (BPTC) measures and the degradation is (a) consistent with the maximum benefit to the people of the State, (b) will not unreasonably affect present and anticipated beneficial use of affected groundwater, and (c) will not exceed water quality objectives.
24. The treatment process incorporates technology for secondary treatment of the County's municipal wastewater, provides for biosolids handling and treatment for reuse, and recycles wastewater at

agronomic rates on U.S. Forest Service land. Control measures include an approved and effective pretreatment program, an active inflow and infiltration (I/I) rehabilitation program, and a capital recovery fund. It also includes a current O&M manual and sufficient staffing to assure proper operation and maintenance. The Discharger must fully implement BPTC measures to maintain permission to discharge. This Order requires the Discharger to initiate this evaluation in the event that groundwater monitoring reveals that discharges to the effluent storage pond has degraded groundwater quality.

GENERAL FINDINGS

25. The DWR has established standards for the construction and deconstruction of groundwater wells (hereafter DWR Well Standards). These standards are described in two DWR publications: *California Well Standards Bulletin 74-90* (June 1991) and *Water Well Standards: State of California Bulletin 74-81* (December 1981).
26. The discharge authorized herein, except for residual sludge and solid waste, is exempt from the requirements of Title 27, CCR, Section 20380 et seq. (hereafter Title 27). The exemption, pursuant to Section 20090(a), is based on:
 - a. The waste consisting of primarily domestic sewage and treated effluent;
 - b. Issuance of these waste discharge requirements consistent with water quality objectives; and
 - c. Exemption of treatment and storage facilities associated with municipal wastewater treatment plants.
27. State regulations pertaining to water quality monitoring for waste management units are found in Title 27. These regulations prescribe procedures for detecting and characterizing the impact of waste constituents on groundwater. While the WWTF has been found exempt from Title 27, the data analysis methods of Title 27 are appropriate for determining whether the discharge complies with the terms for protection of groundwater specified in this Order. As long as the discharge complies, the exemption remains warranted.
28. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
29. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-6-

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 76-25 is rescinded and that Madera County Service Area No. 2 and the United States Forest Service, their agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. Surface runoff of effluent from the sprayfields to surface water or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
3. Bypass or overflow of untreated or partially treated wastes is prohibited, except as allowed by Standard Provision A.13.
4. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous,' as defined in Section 2521(a) of Title 23, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 2510 et seq., (hereinafter Chapter 15), or 'designated,' as defined in Section 13173 of the California Water Code, is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. The discharge from the WWTF shall not exceed the following limits:

<u>Constituents/Parameters</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Monthly Average</u>	<u>7-day Median</u>	<u>Daily Maximum</u>
Flow	mgd	0.5		0.65
BOD ₅ ¹	mg/L	40		80
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	40		80
Settleable Solids	mL/L	0.2		0.5
<u>Total Coliform</u>	MPN ² /100mL		50	500

¹ Five-day, biochemical oxygen demand at 20°C

² Most Probable Number

2. Effluent in the storage pond shall not have a pH less than 6.5 or greater than 9.5.
3. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the WWTF.

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-7-

4. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification B.3, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of effluent in the storage pond shall not be less than 1.0 mg/L.
5. The storage pond shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitoes. In particular:
 - a. Weeds shall not become established within or around the storage pond's inner perimeter.
 - b. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the storage pond's water surface.
6. Public contact with wastewater in the treatment, storage, and sprayfield areas shall be precluded through such means as fences and signs, or acceptable alternatives.
7. The storage pond shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow, design seasonal precipitation, ancillary inflow and infiltration, and storm water collected at the WWTF. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on total annual precipitation using a return period of 100 years, distributed monthly in accordance with historical rainfall patterns. Pond freeboard shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically).
8. On or about **1 October of each year**, available effluent storage pond capacity shall be at least equal to the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specification B.7.

C. Sprayfield Specifications:

1. Discharge to the sprayfields during rainfall or 12 hours after rainfall is prohibited.
2. Signs with proper wording of sufficient size shall be placed at areas of public access to the sprayfields to alert the public of the discharge of treated wastewater.
3. Posted signs at the sprayfield shall be printed in English and Spanish with the following statement in a size that can be clearly read by the public:
 - a. "RECYCLED WASTEWATER—DO NOT DRINK—WASH THOROUGHLY WITH SOAP AND DRINKING WATER IF CONTACT OCCURS."
 - b. "AGUA DE DESPERDICIO RECLAMADA—POR FAVOR NO TOME—SI HAY CONTACTO CON LA AGUA, LAVASE BIEN CON JABON Y AGUA DE TOMAR."

- c. The international sign presented in Attachment C shall be posted on access roads and on the perimeter of the subject areas.

D. Sludge (Biosolids) Disposal Specifications:

1. Collected screenings, biosolids, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner approved by the Executive Officer and, and if by land application, shall be consistent with *State Water Resources Control Board Water Quality Order No. 2000-10-DWQ, General Waste Discharge Requirements for the Discharge of Biosolids to Land for Use as a Soil Amendment in Agricultural, Silvicultural, Horticultural, and Land Reclamation Activities (General Order)*.
2. Use and disposal of sewage sludge via land application for use as a soil amendment shall comply with *State Water Resources Control Board Water Quality Order No. 2000-10-DWQ, General Waste Discharge Requirements for the Discharge of Biosolids to Land for Use as a Soil Amendment in Agricultural, Silvicultural, Horticultural, and Land Reclamation Activities (General Order)*.

E. Groundwater Limitations:

1. Neither the WWTF operation nor its discharges to land or to the effluent storage pond, alone or in combination with other sources, shall cause or threaten to cause degradation of area groundwater inconsistent with the State Antidegradation Policy, State Water Resources Control Board Resolution No. 68-16.

F. Provisions:

1. The Discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) No. 5-00-232, which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."
3. The Discharger shall comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-9-

4. The Discharger shall not allow pollutant-free wastewater to be discharged into the collection, treatment, and disposal system in amounts that significantly diminish the system's capability to comply with this Order. Pollutant-free wastewater means rainfall, groundwater, cooling waters, and condensates that without treatment are essentially free of pollutants.
5. **By 1 February 2001**, the Discharger shall submit a technical report about the WWTF collection system that includes, at a minimum: (1) the dates that the 1995 Work Plan actions were (or will be) completed and all pertinent details, (2) information on any additional collection system improvements (both structural and operational) and the dates they were completed, and (3) an up-to-date engineering evaluation of the collection system's adequacy in preventing overflow discharges. The technical report shall be signed (and stamped) by a California registered civil engineer experienced in wastewater collection systems.
6. **By 1 August 2001**, the Discharger shall submit a technical report evaluating the WWTF storage and disposal capacity. The technical report shall include: (1) a description of sprayfield soils (i.e., classification, depth, and infiltration/percolation rates); (2) a land survey showing natural drainages, topographical features, slope gradients, and sprayfield components; and (3) a water balance that incorporates the desired discharge flow, estimated infiltration and inflow, and a design seasonal precipitation using a return frequency of 100 years and distributed monthly in accordance with historical rainfall patterns. The sprayfield disposal capacity used in the water balance must be based on, or consistent with, the site-specific information requested in (1) and (2) above, and preclude effluent runoff during wet weather and shall include, if necessary, an evaluation and recommendation for the installation of an effluent return system. The technical report shall be signed (and stamped) by a California registered civil engineer experienced in wastewater land disposal.
7. If the disposal capacity determined by the technical report of Provision F.6 is less than the discharge flow permitted herein, this Order will be reopened and modified before WWTF flow exceeds the disposal capacity. If WWTF flow is found to already exceed disposal capacity, this Order will be promptly reopened and modified. Modifications to the Order may include a reduction in the allowable discharge flow, more stringent disinfection requirements, or other measures.
8. **By 31 December 2000**, the Discharger shall install a permanent marker in the effluent storage pond with calibrations indicating the water level at design capacity and available operational freeboard in vertical feet.
9. At least **90 days** prior to a termination in the existing agreement between the County and the USFS for the County's use of USFS property for effluent disposal, the Discharger shall notify the Board in writing of the situation and of what measures have been taken or are being taken to assure full compliance with this Order.

10. The Discharger's groundwater monitoring network should provide for accurate characterization of groundwater quality and determination of groundwater gradient and direction of flow in the vicinity of, surrounding, and downgradient of the WWTF's effluent storage pond. The Discharger shall submit for Executive Officer approval, a technical report describing the installation of groundwater monitoring wells.

The technical report shall consist of a Monitoring Well Installation Workplan for the network that satisfies Attachment D, "Standard Monitoring Well Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements." The network shall consist of one or more background monitoring wells, one or more internal monitoring wells, and one or more boundary monitoring wells capable of yielding representative samples from the uppermost layer of water representative of the uppermost aquifer located where groundwater quality limitations apply. All monitoring wells shall meet DWR Well Standards in addition to performance standards prescribed by Title 27, Section 20415(b)(4) et seq. All locations and construction features for additional monitoring wells are subject to the prior approval of the Executive Officer and must be sufficient to monitor potential impacts on the uppermost groundwater aquifer from the effluent storage pond.

After completing the installation of approved groundwater monitoring wells, the Discharger shall submit a technical report in the form of Monitoring Well Installation Report of Results, as described in Attachment D. The Discharger shall comply with the following compliance schedule in conducting the groundwater monitoring well installation project.

The Discharger shall characterize background groundwater quality using data from approved background well(s) using methods as described by Title 27, Section 20415(e)(10). The Discharger shall use these background values and quarterly monitoring well data and an appropriate data analysis method, as described by Title 27, Section 20415(e)(7-9), to determine whether there is statistically significant evidence that concentrations of waste constituents in monitoring wells exceed groundwater quality limits. The Discharger shall comply with the following compliance schedule in conducting the groundwater monitoring well installation project and implementing the groundwater monitoring program:

<u>Task</u>	<u>Compliance Date</u>
Submit technical report containing a Monitoring Well Installation Workplan (see Attachment D)	1 July 2001
Implement Monitoring Well Installation Workplan	60 days following Work Plan approval

<u>Task</u>	<u>Compliance Date</u>
Complete Monitoring Well Installation	60 days following Work Plan implementation
Submit Monitoring Well Installation Report of Results (see Attachment D)	30 days following Project Completion
Commence groundwater monitoring in accordance with the MRP	30 days following Project Completion
Characterize background groundwater quality and assess compliance with antidegradation requirements	365 days after commencing groundwater monitoring

All reports submitted pursuant to this Provision shall be prepared and certified by a California registered civil engineer or hydrogeologist. Following Executive Officer approval of the submittals, this Provision shall be considered satisfied. The Discharger shall submit to the Board on, or before each compliance date, the specified document or written report detailing compliance or noncompliance with the specific task and date. If noncompliance is reported, the Discharger shall state the reasons for noncompliance and include an estimate of the date when the Discharger will be in compliance. The Discharger shall notify the Board by letter when it returns to compliance with the time schedule.

11. If the Discharger during any quarterly data evaluation finds statistically significant evidence of an increase in waste constituents in groundwater compared to background levels, the Discharger shall conclude that the discharge caused the increase unless it can demonstrate that the increase was due to an offsite source. Within **90 days** of concluding that the discharge has caused the increase, the Discharger shall initiate an Antidegradation Analysis to determine whether the discharge reflects the implementation of best practicable treatment and control (BPTC) and is consistent with the State Antidegradation Policy.

In performing the Antidegradation Analysis, the Discharger shall take into consideration the environmental characteristics of the hydrogeologic unit encompassing the WWTF's effluent storage pond and the spray field; the demands being made on and to be made on the groundwater and the total values involved, beneficial and detrimental, economic and social, tangible and intangible. The evaluation of economic feasibility shall include, at a minimum, consideration of current, planned, and future land use, in addition to social and economic impacts to the affected area, including property owners other than the County or U.S. Forest Service. Economic considerations shall be an objective balancing of the incremental benefit of allowing water quality to decrease to less than background quality as compared with the incremental cost of maintaining or restoring background quality.

In performing the Antidegradation Analysis, the Discharger shall submit a technical report that describes the magnitude and extent of the groundwater degradation caused by the discharge of effluent to the County's effluent storage pond and the U.S. Forest Service spray field. Additionally, the technical report shall contain the following:

- a. The results of an engineering evaluation of the Discharger's sludge management relative to the highest intent of BPTC, and a proposal describing modifications to the Discharger's sludge management, along with an implementation schedule that, once completed, will raise it to a standard that reflects BPTC; and/or
- b. The results of a study to assess the extent to which area groundwater has been degraded by the discharge of effluent to the effluent storage pond, and a proposal describing necessary modifications to the effluent (e.g., reducing its nitrogen content) and/or to the manner in which effluent is discharged to the effluent storage pond (e.g., sealing the pond), along with an implementation schedule that, once completed, will raise the discharge of effluent to a standard that reflects BPTC.
- c. For degradation that cannot be justified under the Antidegradation Analysis, a proposal and schedule for groundwater cleanup to restore groundwater to the concentrations that can be justified under the Antidegradation Policy.

The Discharger shall complete the Antidegradation Analysis **within three years** after its initiation and shall conduct whatever additional investigation is directed or approved by the Executive Officer as necessary to complete this task. The Discharger shall submit written quarterly status reports to the Board on the progress of its Antidegradation Analysis beginning **within 90 days** after initiating work on the analysis, with each subsequent report due the **1st day of the second month following the end of each calendar quarter** thereafter. Hydrogeologic investigations shall be completed and certified by qualified registered civil engineers or by properly registered and qualified geologists, engineering geologists, or hydrogeologists. Evaluations of WWTF discharge practices relative to the highest intent of BPTC shall be completed and certified by qualified registered civil engineers. All reports, plans, and conclusions are subject to the approval of the Executive Officer.

If the Discharger proposes to implement BPTC measures for its discharge of effluent to the effluent storage pond, the Board shall evaluate the Discharger's proposal for BPTC implementation to determine whether it is reasonable and shall consider adopting a time schedule for the Discharger to complete the proposed work. If the Board determines that the Discharger has already fully implemented BPTC, or will fully implement BPTC pursuant to a Board-adopted time schedule, the Board may reopen this Order for consideration of adopting numerical limitations for groundwater passing beneath and downgradient the WWTF vicinity

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-13-

that are consistent with maximum benefit to the people of the State, will not unreasonably affect present and anticipated beneficial use of affected groundwater, and will not exceed water quality objectives.

12. If the Board determines that waste constituents in the discharge have reasonable potential to cause or contribute to an exceedance of a limit for groundwater, this Order may be enforced or, alternately, reopened for consideration of addition or revision of appropriate numerical effluent or groundwater limitations for the problem constituents.
13. The Discharger shall use best practical treatment and control, including proper operation and maintenance, to comply with the terms of this Order.
14. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.

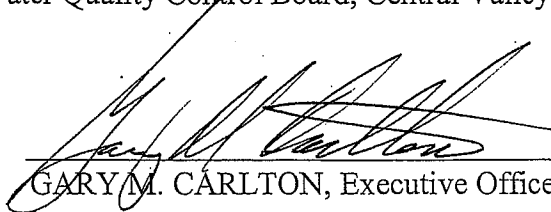
To assume operation under this Order, the succeeding owner or operator must apply in writing to the Executive Officer requesting transfer of the Order. The request must contain the requesting entity's full legal name, the state of incorporation if a corporation, the name and address and telephone number of the persons responsible for contact with the Board, and a statement. The statement shall comply with the signatory paragraph of Standard Provision B.3 and state that the proposed owner or operator assumes full responsibility for compliance with this Order. Failure to submit the request shall be considered a discharge without requirements, a violation of the California Water Code. Transfer shall be approved or disapproved by the Executive Officer.

15. A copy of this Order and its attachments shall be kept at the WWTF for reference by operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
16. If reclaimed water is used for construction purposes, it shall comply with the most current edition of "Guidelines for Use of Reclaimed Water for Construction Purposes." Other uses of reclaimed water not specifically authorized herein shall be subject to revision of this Order and compliance with Title 22, CCR, Section 6031 et seq.
17. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-14-

I, GARY M CARLTON, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 27 October 2000.



GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer

CTS/blh:fmc:10/27/00

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM ORDER NO. 5-00-232
FOR
MADERA COUNTY SERVICE AREA NO. 2
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BASS LAKE WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MADERA COUNTY

Specific sample station locations shall be established with concurrence of the Board's staff. The Discharger shall submit a description of the stations to the Board and attach to its own copy of this Order a copy of the sample station description. Board staff will ask to see and refer to the description while conducting on-site compliance inspections.

INFLUENT MONITORING

Influent samples shall be collected at the inlet of the headworks and at approximately the same time as effluent samples. Influent monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Total Daily Flow	mgd	Metered	Continuous ¹
Monthly Average of Total Daily Flow	mgd	Computed	Monthly
Monthly Peak Daily Flow			
Daily Flow	mgd		Monthly
BOD ₅ ²	mg/L	8-hr Composite ³	Weekly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	8-hr Composite ³	Weekly

¹ Recorded daily

² Five-day, biochemical oxygen demand at 20°C

³ Composite samples may consist of flow-proportioned grab samples.

EFFLUENT MONITORING

Effluent samples shall be collected just prior to discharge to the storage pond. Effluent samples shall be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge. Time of collection of grab and composite samples shall be recorded. Effluent monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Settleable Solids	mL/L	Grab	2/Weekly ¹
Chlorine Residual	mg/L	Grab	2/Weekly ¹

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-2-

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Total Coliform	MPN ⁴ /100mL	Grab	Weekly
EC ⁵	µmhos/cm	Grab	Monthly
<u>General Minerals</u> ⁶	mg/L	8-hr Composite ²	Quarterly ⁷

¹ On nonconsecutive days

² Composite samples may consist of flow-proportioned grab samples.

³ Concurrent with BOD₅ influent sampling

⁴ Most probable number

⁵ Conductivity at 25°C

⁶ General minerals referred to in this program shall include at least total dissolved solids, chloride, sulfate, nitrate, bicarbonate alkalinity, calcium, magnesium, potassium, sodium, iron, manganese, and all major anions and cations. Analyses should be accompanied by an anion-cation balance demonstrating that analyses are complete.

⁷ January, April, July, and October

STORAGE POND MONITORING

The storage pond shall be monitored as follows:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
pH	pH units	Grab	Weekly
Freeboard	feet	Observation	Weekly
<u>Dissolved Oxygen</u>	mg/L	Grab ¹	Weekly ²

¹ Samples shall be collected at a depth of one foot, opposite the inlet. Dissolved oxygen samples shall be collected between 0800 and 0900 hours.

² If results indicate a concentration of less than 1.0 mg/L or if offensive odors are noted in violation of Discharge Specification B.3 and B.4, the frequency of monitoring shall be increased as necessary to characterize the period of noncompliance.

Permanent markers shall be placed in the storage pond with calibrations indicating the water level at design capacity and available operational freeboard, as described in Provision F.7.

GROUNDWATER MONITORING

Samples shall be collected from wells in the approved monitoring well network and analyzed for the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Total Organic Carbon	mg/L	Quarterly ¹
EC	µmhos/cm	Quarterly ¹
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen	mg/L	Quarterly ¹
Nitrate-Nitrogen	mg/L	Quarterly ¹
Total Nitrogen (calculated)	mg/L	Quarterly
Iron (dissolved) ²	mg/L	Quarterly ¹
Manganese (dissolved) ²	mg/L	Quarterly
Total Dissolved Solids ³	mg/L	Quarterly ¹
Standard Minerals ⁴	mg/L	Quarterly ¹
Total Coliform	MPN/100mL	Quarterly ¹
pH ¹	pH Units	Quarterly ¹

¹ January, April, July, and October

² Samples shall pass through a 0.45 µm filter

³ Determined by USEPA Method 160.1

⁴ Standard minerals shall include bicarbonate, calcium, carbonate, chloride, fluoride, potassium, sodium, sulfate, and total phosphorus

Prior to collecting samples, the monitoring well shall be adequately purged to remove water that has been standing within the well screen and casing that may not be chemically representative of formation water. Depending on the hydraulic conductivity of the geologic setting, the volume removed during purging is typically from 3 to 5 volumes of the standing water within the well casing and screen, or additionally the filter pack pore volume.

At least quarterly and concurrently with groundwater quality sampling, prior to monitoring well purging and sampling, the Discharger shall measure the water level in each well. The Discharger shall report water level data as groundwater depth (in feet and hundredths) and as groundwater surface elevation (in feet and hundredths above mean sea level). The horizontal geodetic location for each monitoring well shall be provided where the point of beginning shall be described by the California State Plane

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-4-

Coordinate System, 1983 datum. The Discharger shall include in its quarterly submittal of groundwater elevation data, a contour map based on said data showing the gradient and direction of groundwater flow under/around the WWTF.

After one full year of groundwater monitoring, the Discharger shall analyze monitoring data from background well(s) to compute background water quality values for each constituent and to perform an initial assessment of whether there is evidence of an impact from the discharge. To complete this task, the Discharger shall use monitoring data from background and from internal and boundary compliance monitoring wells in an appropriate data analysis method as described in Title 27, Section 20415(e)(7-9). Reports thereafter shall be submitted quarterly by the **1st day of the second month** after the prescribed sample collection and shall include the same analysis.

If the Discharger during any quarterly data evaluation finds statistically significant evidence of an increase in a waste constituent in groundwater compared to background levels, the Discharger shall conclude that the discharge caused the increase unless it can demonstrate that it was due to an offsite source. The Discharger shall describe the data analysis method used as well as the criteria it used for determining "statistically significant evidence."

By **1 February** of each year, the Discharger shall submit an Annual Groundwater Monitoring Report covering the previous monitoring year. The reporting period ends December 31. This report shall contain:

- a. Hydrographs showing the groundwater elevation in each approved well for at least the previous five years. The hydrographs should show groundwater elevation with respect to the elevations of the top and bottom of the screened interval and be presented at a scale of values appropriate to show trends or variations in groundwater elevation. The scale of the background plots shall be the same as that used to plot downgradient elevation data;
- b. A description and graphical presentation of the gradient and direction of groundwater flow under the area encompassing the effluent storage pond;
- c. Graphs of the laboratory analytical data for all samples taken from each approved well within at least the previous five calendar years. Each such graph shall plot the concentration of one or more Constituents of Concern over time for a given monitoring well, at a scale appropriate to show trends or variations in water quality. The graphs shall plot each datum, rather than plotting mean values. For any given constituent or parameter, the scale for the background plots shall be the same as that used to plot downgradient data;

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-5-

- d. All monitoring analytical data obtained during the previous four quarterly reporting periods, presented in tabular form, as well as 3.5" computer diskettes (or submitted separately via e-mail), either in MS-DOS / ASCII format or in another file format acceptable to the Executive Officer (e.g., Microsoft Excel); and
- e. A comprehensive discussion of the compliance record, and the result of any corrective actions taken or planned that may be needed to bring the Discharger into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

SLUDGE (BIOSOLIDS) MONITORING AND REPORTING

Biosolids monitoring, record keeping, characterization, storage, and disposal shall be in accordance with 40 CFR 503, Title 27, and, if applied to land as a soil amendment, *State Water Resources Control Board Water Quality Order No. 2000-10-DWQ General Waste Discharge Requirements for the Discharge of Biosolids to Land for Use as a Soil Amendment in Agricultural, Silvicultural, Horticultural, and Land Reclamation Activities (General Order)*. Sampling records shall be retained for a minimum of five years. The Discharger shall keep a bound logbook containing entries describing the biosolids quantities generated, the handling and disposal activities, and the final disposal or reclamation site receiving the biosolids. Information from the logbook shall be summarized and submitted in the Annual Report discussed below.

WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

A sampling station shall be established where a representative sample of the County Service Area No. 2 water supply can be obtained. If the source water is from more than one source, the results shall be reported as a flow-weighted average and include copies of supporting calculations. Water supply monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituents</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
<u>General Minerals</u>	mg/L	Quarterly ¹

¹ January, April, July, and October for the first year, annually (i.e., every October) thereafter upon Executive Officer approval.

REPORTING

Weekly, biweekly, monthly, and quarterly monitoring data shall be reported in monthly monitoring reports submitted to the Board by the **1st day of the second month following sample collection**. Annual monitoring reports shall be submitted by **1 February of each year**. All reports submitted in response to this Order shall comply with the signatory requirements in Standard Provision B.3.

MADERA CSA NO. 2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

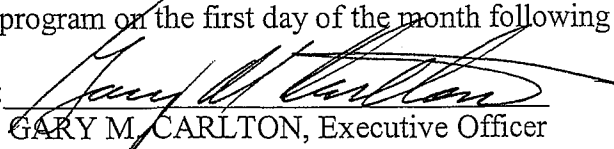
In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner that illustrates clearly whether the Discharger complies with waste discharge requirements, including calculation of all averages, etc. If violations of waste discharge requirements have occurred, the report shall discuss the corrective actions taken and planned to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements. If the Discharger monitors any waste constituent at the locations designated herein more frequently than is required by this Order, the results of such monitoring shall be included in the monthly monitoring report. The Discharger may also be requested to submit an annual report to the Board with tabular and graphical summaries of the monitoring data obtained during the previous year. Any such request shall be made in writing.

By **1 February of each year**, the Discharger shall submit a written Annual Report to the Executive Officer containing the following:

- a. The names, titles, certificate grade, and general responsibilities of persons operating and maintaining the wastewater treatment facility.
- b. The names and telephone numbers of persons to contact regarding the plant for emergency and routine situations.
- c. A certified statement of when the flow meter and other monitoring instruments and devices were last calibrated, including identification of who did the calibration (Standard Provision C.4).
- d. A statement whether the current O&M manual and contingency plan reflect the wastewater treatment plant as currently constructed and operated, and the dates when these documents were last reviewed for adequacy.
- e. Annual biosolids monitoring information as specified in Biosolids Monitoring and Reporting.
- f. The results of an annual evaluation conducted pursuant to Standard Provision E.4

The Discharger shall implement the above monitoring program on the first day of the month following adoption of this Order.

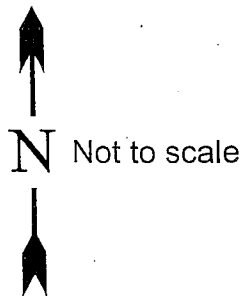
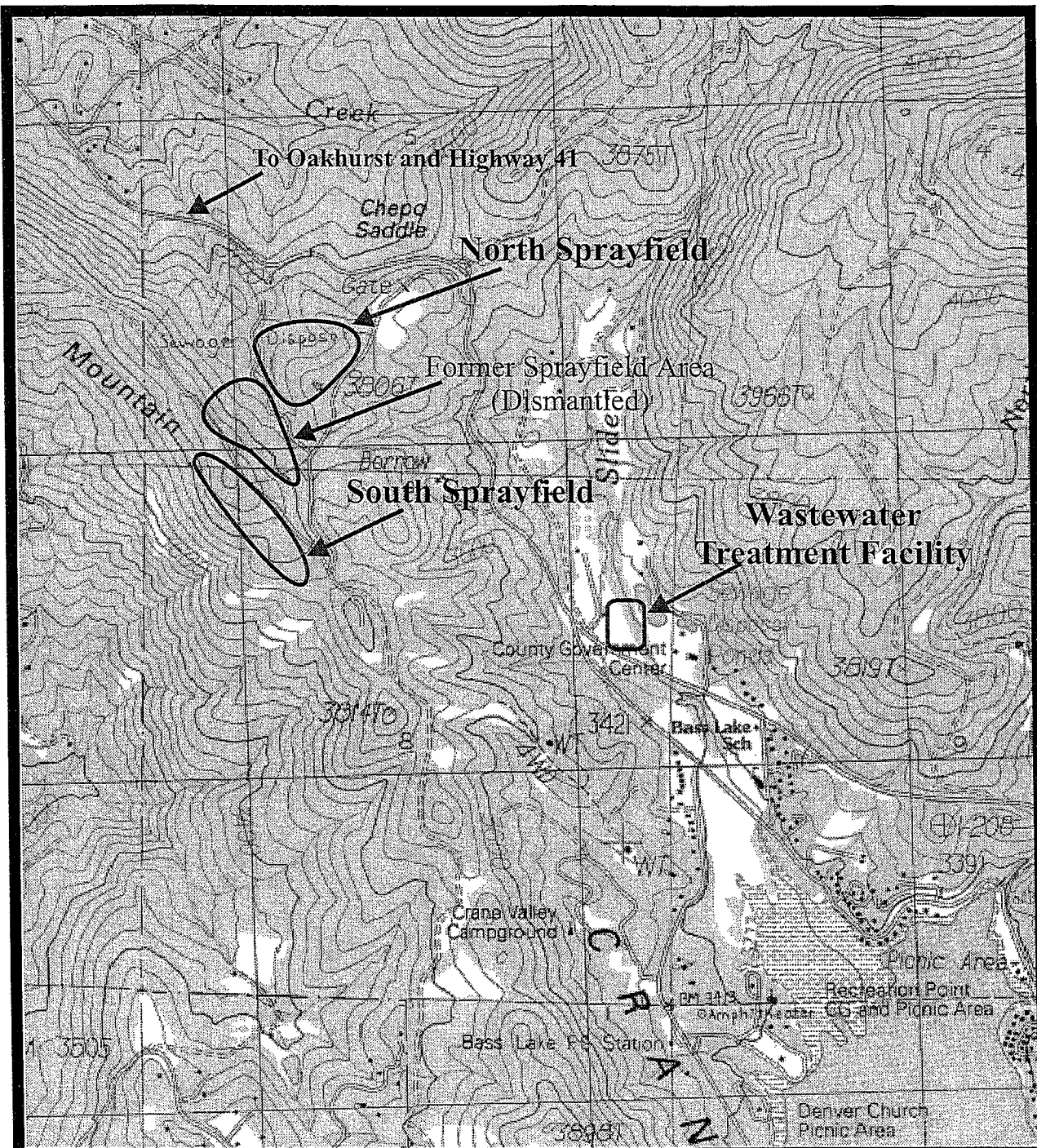
Ordered by:


GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer

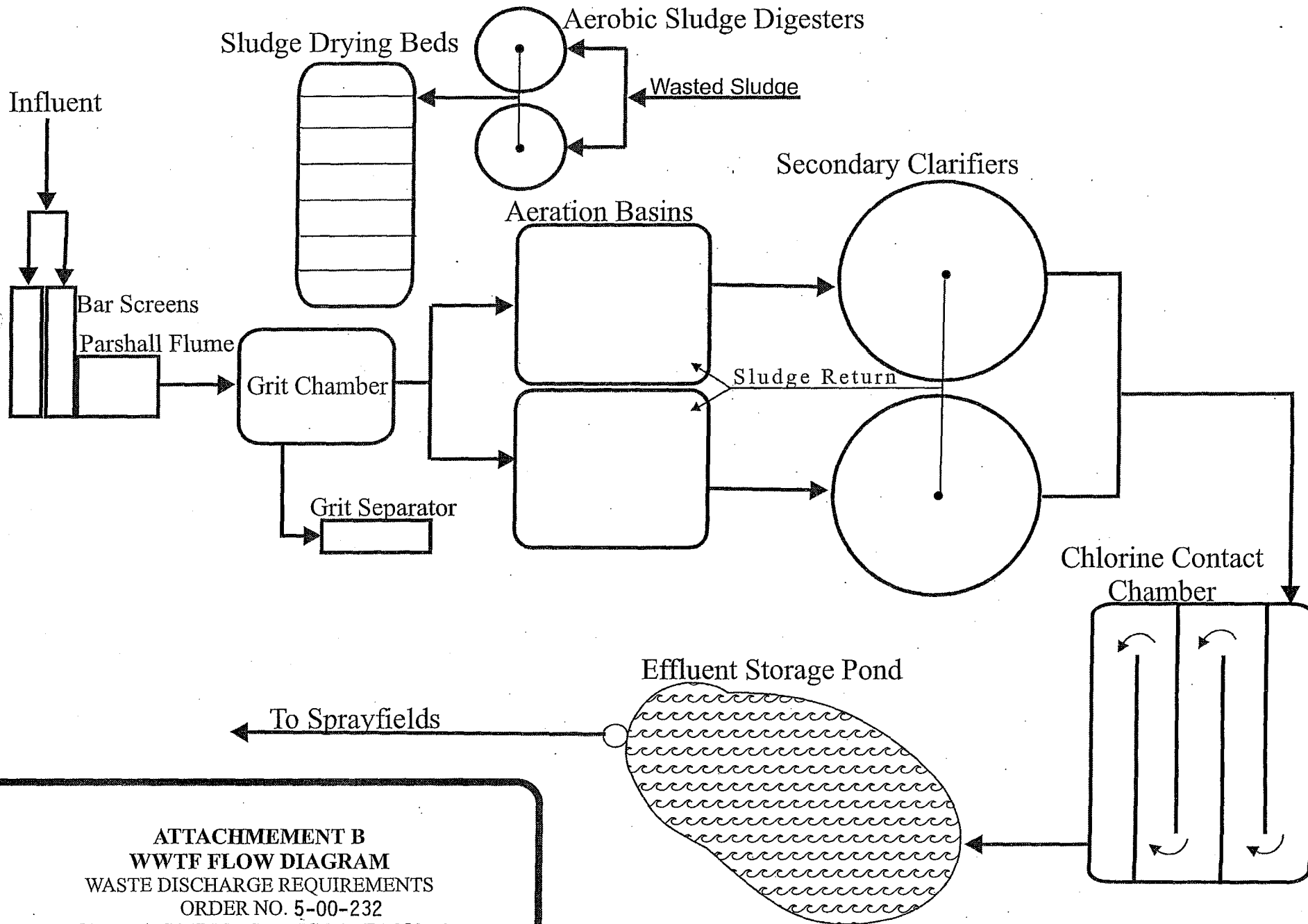
27 October 2000

(Date)

CTS/blh:fmc10/27/00



ATTACHMENT A
WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA COUNTY SERVICE AREA NO. 2
UNITED STATES FOREST SERVICE
BASS LAKE WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MADERA COUNTY
VICINITY MAP
 Section 9, T7S, R22E, MDB&M
 Sections 5&8, T7S, R22E MDB&M
 Bass Lake, CA 7.5 Min. Quad Map



ATTACHMEMENT B
WWTF FLOW DIAGRAM
 WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
 ORDER NO. 5-00-232
 MADERA COUNTY SERVICE AREA NO. 2
 AND
 UNITED STATES FOREST SERVICE
 BASS LAKE WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
 MADERA COUNTY



ATTACHMENT C

RECOMMENDED SYMBOL

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-232

**MADERA COUNTY SERVICE AREA NO. 2 AND
UNITED STATES FOREST SERVICE
BASS LAKE WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MADERA COUNTY**

INFORMATION SHEET

ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA COUNTY SERVICE AREA NO. 2 AND
UNITED STATES FOREST SERVICE
BASS LAKE WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MADERA COUNTY

Madera County Service Area No. 2 (hereafter Discharger or County) owns and operates a wastewater collection system and treatment facility (WWTF) that provides sewage service for the Bass Lake area. The WWTF includes headworks, two aeration basins, two secondary clarifiers, two open-air aerobic sludge digesters, chlorine contact basin, unlined effluent storage pond, seven concrete sludge drying beds, and sprayfield disposal system. The WWTF has reported average and peak design flows of 0.50 million gallons per day (mgd) and 0.65 mgd, respectively. The WWTF headworks include a comminutor, aerated grit chamber, grit separator, Parshall flume, and flow totalizer. The sludge drying beds comprise a total area of 10,500 square feet, and the 4.2-million-gallon storage pond provides 8.3 days of storage at 0.50 mgd. The WWTF (not including sprayfields) is at an elevation of about 3400 feet in Section 9, T7S, R22E, MDB&M.

Effluent is disposed of via sprinkler application on two sprayfields about 1.5 miles to the northwest of the treatment facility on Taylor Mountain at an elevation of about 3,600 feet in the southwest quarter of Section 5, and northwest quarter of Section 8, T7S, R22E, MDB&M. The sprayfields are on a 104-acre fenced parcel of land owned by the United States Forest Service (USFS), with whom the Discharger has a special use permit for use of the land. The southern sprayfield, on the crest and slopes of Taylor Mountain, is approximately 11 acres in size, and has 47 lateral lines and 159 sprinklers. The northern sprayfield, on the north slope of the mountain, is approximately 20 acres in size and has 16 lateral lines and an undisclosed number of sprinklers. The sprayfield disposal system originally included three sprayfields, each with a reported size of about 20 acres. However, one of the sprayfields was never completed, as shown on plans, and is only about 11 acres in size. The original third sprayfield, located between the existing northern and southern sprayfields, was dismantled following freeze damage and past chronic problems with effluent runoff entering an adjacent natural drainage. The current disposal capacity of the sprayfields is unknown.

COLLECTION SYSTEM SPILL HISTORY

Accidental WWTF collection system discharges to Bass Lake have occurred numerous times over the last ten years. Because the majority of the WWTF collection system is within one half mile of the lake's shoreline, and a portion lies along the lake bottom, any system spills have a high probability of entering the waters of Bass Lake. Between December 1991 and July 1994, the County had seven documented raw sewage discharges (overflows) from the WWTF collection system to the lake. On 10 August 1994, the Board issued Administrative Civil Liability Order No. 94-285 for the illegal discharges. In February 1995, the Discharger submitted a technical report, *Wastewater Collection and Pumping Station Work Plan Report* (1995 Work Plan) that contained recommendations to prevent or reduce future spills by thoroughly cleaning the collection system, hiring additional WWTF operation and maintenance personnel, mailing notices to the public instructing them to abstain from flushing items which could

INFORMATION SHEET – ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO.2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-2-

cause collection system blockages, and investigating all food establishments for compliance with the County's grease trap ordinance.

Following submittal of the 1995 Work Plan, the County reported the occurrence of an additional eight raw sewage discharges from the WWTF collection system to Bass Lake (between January 1995 and September 1998). The County reported that power, electrical, and lift pump failures caused about 50% of the spills, and that blockages, usually involving grease, were responsible for most of the remaining discharges. The County reported its response actions for each spill to the lake (i.e., removing a blockage and posting the lake with warning signs and sampling it for fecal coliform), but has not submitted written information on overall and specific system improvements completed and actions taken to prevent future occurrences.

A staff memo, dated 22 December 1998 (1998 Memo), recommended the Board not take immediate enforcement action for the spills and cited reasons including the County's responsive mitigative actions following the spills, the absence of lasting impacts to the lake's beneficial uses, and the size of potential civil liability relative to the cost of taking such an action. The 1998 Memo also indicates that staff contacted the Discharger and requested that it provide information on the status of implementation of the recommendations in the 1995 Report. The Discharger's file does not contain any record of a response from the County. However, the frequency of spills reported by the County between January 1995 and the present time have decreased. Between September 1998 and the present time, the County reported one WWTF collection system discharge (an estimated 1,000 gallons of raw sewage entered the lake during January 2000). While the frequency of such discharges appear to have been significantly reduced since September 1998, the Discharger has not submitted written information on or confirmation of actions that it has completed to implement the recommendations of the 1995 Work Plan, or on additional collection system improvements or efforts to eliminate sewage spills to the lake. However, a 26 July 2000 inspection report indicates that the Discharger is improving the collection system's electronic monitoring system. A provision in this Order requires the Discharger to submit a status report on completed or planned actions to prevent further collection system discharges and a technical report describing an engineering evaluation of the system's adequacy.

ADDITIONAL BACKGROUND

Order No. 76-25 contains the following waste discharge specifications:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Monthly Average</u>	<u>Monthly Median</u>	<u>Weekly Average</u>	<u>Daily Maximum</u>
BOD ₅ ¹	mg/L	40	--	45	80
Suspended Solids	mg/L	40	--	45	80
Settleable Solids	mL/L	0.2	--	--	1.0
Total Coliform	MPN/100mL	--	50	--	500

According to Discharger self-monitoring reports for the period of May 1999 to May 2000, influent and effluent (The Discharger collects effluent samples from the outflow of the chlorine contact chamber) BOD₅ has averaged about 170 mg/L and 8 mg/l, respectively, and storage pond DO averaged about 12 mg/L. The minimum and maximum average monthly WWTF flows for the same period were 0.15 and 0.32 mgd, respectively. WWTF flows for the period of June to September 1999 averaged approximately 0.25 mgd, and for the period of December 1999 to February 2000, flows averaged 0.16 mgd. WWTF flows are highest during the summer because the Bass Lake region is a summer resort and recreation area. Infiltration and inflow (I/I) to the WWTF collection system does not appear to be significant.

The Discharger removes dried sludge from the sludge-drying beds with hand shovels and wheelbarrows, and stores it nearby in piles on the earth. All stored sludge is removed before the wet season begins with final disposal at the Fairmead Landfill near Chowchilla. During the winter, if wet weather prevents the sludge from drying in the beds and being suitable for transport and disposal as a solid waste, excess sludge will be taken to the City of Madera WWTF, or removed by a licensed hauler.

EFFLUENT LIMITS

This Order's BOD and total suspended solids monthly average effluent limits of 40 mg/L (80 mg/L daily maximum) each reflect the level of treatment that the WWTF is designed to achieve, are carried over from the previous Order, and are consistent with other orders of this type. The total coliform 7-day median and daily maximum effluent limits of 50 and 500 MPN/100 mL, respectively, have been carried over from the previous Order. More stringent limits (i.e., 23 and 240 MPN/100 mL) are not necessary, as the sprayfield disposal area is remote and isolated.

UNLINED EFFLUENT STORAGE POND

Groundwater degradation resulting from the discharge of effluent to an unlined effluent storage pond overlying shallow groundwater is not consistent with the State Antidegradation Policy. This Order requires the Discharger to monitor the quality of groundwater underlying the WWTF's unlined effluent storage pond. After one year of quarterly monitoring for groundwater quality in the vicinity of the effluent storage pond, the Discharger is required to determine whether the discharge is causing or contributing to cause an increase in concentrations of waste constituents in groundwater over background concentrations. If monitoring data indicate the discharge is causing or contributing to cause the increase, this Permit requires the Discharger to initiate an Antidegradation Analysis to determine what modifications are necessary, and an implementation schedule, to raise its operations to a standard that reflects BPTC consistent with State Antidegradation Policy.

SOILS, GEOLOGY, AND HYDROLOGY

The sprayfields are on mild to moderate slopes, appear to have well-developed soils in most areas, and are covered with forest vegetation and organic matter. Surface water runoff from the northern sprayfield, on the northern slope of Taylor Mountain, drains to the north into Redwood Creek, a tributary of Nelder Creek, which flows into the Fresno River near Oakhurst. Surface water runoff from the southern sprayfield, on the southern slope of the mountain, drains to the southwest into an unnamed stream flowing through the Oakhurst Valley and into the Fresno River in Oakhurst.

Surface water runoff from the WWTF (area of its treatment units) is to Slide Creek, which flows into Bass Lake about one mile from the WWTF. Bass Lake is an impoundment of Willow Creek created in the 1920's for hydroelectric power generation. The lake receives heavy water contact and noncontact water recreational use, especially during summer months. Willow Creek flows into the San Joaquin River above Millerton Lake. The average annual rainfall in the WWTF vicinity (at Crane Valley Powerhouse) is approximately 39 inches, and the 100-year return period annual rainfall is about 79 inches, according to DWR Bulletin No. 195. In the vicinity of (and on) the sprayfields, snow typically accumulates to a depth of up to two feet and remains on the ground for a week or two before melting off.

The beneficial uses of Fresno River from its source to Hidden Reservoir are municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, water contact recreation, noncontact water recreation, warm freshwater habitat, cold freshwater habitat, and wildlife habitat. The beneficial uses of the San Joaquin River from its source to Millerton Lake are municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, hydropower generation, water contact recreation, noncontact water recreation, warm freshwater habitat, cold freshwater habitat, and wildlife habitat.

Groundwater depth information is not available for the WWTF and sprayfield area. The sprayfields cover both hilltop and hillside areas and groundwater undoubtedly varies with location and is probably found within fractured bedrock, known to predominate the area's lithology.

The beneficial uses of groundwater underlying the WWTF (including the sprayfields) are municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, industrial service supply, and industrial process supply.

ANTIDEGRADATION AND CEQA

The conditional discharge as permitted herein is consistent with the antidegradation provisions of State Water Resources Control Board Resolution No. 68-16. The WWTF provides secondary treatment and disinfection and the effluent disposal sprayfields are remote and inaccessible to the public (fenced and posted). The Order assures a minimum level of secondary treatment and requires the Discharger to develop a groundwater monitoring network and program to assure that any impacts to groundwater from

INFORMATION SHEET – ORDER NO. 5-00-232
MADERA CSA NO.2 AND USFS
BASS LAKE WWTF
MADERA COUNTY

-5-

the storage pond do not exceed the limits herein. While the Order's groundwater limits apply to groundwater underlying the sprayfields, requirements for groundwater monitoring are limited to the WWTF's effluent storage pond area, as it would not be practicable to implement groundwater monitoring at the sprayfield area, which is dispersed over variable mountain terrain overlying fractured bedrock. The current sprayfield operation does not appear to pose a reasonable potential for groundwater degradation. Because the true disposal capacity of the sprayfields (with respect to preventing surface runoff) is unknown, a provision in this Order requires the Discharger to submit an engineering technical report to evaluate the matter. The Order does not allow downgradient groundwater concentrations beyond the boundaries WWTF property, as measured at internal monitoring wells, to exceed background water quality for any constituent.

The action to adopt waste discharge requirements for this existing facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15301.

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